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BANTU

Programming Language

v1.2.2 — Stable Release

Official Language Guide & Toolchain Reference

[include modules](#) · [PostgreSQL](#) · [MySQL](#) · [WebRTC](#) · [VSCode extension](#) · [cross-platform installer](#)

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v1.2.2 STABLE

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1. Introduction to Bantu

Bantu is a high-level, dynamically-typed programming language implemented as a tree-walking interpreter in C++17. The entire toolchain — interpreter, package manager, HTTP server, WebRTC engine, SQLite/PostgreSQL/MySQL drivers, project scaffolding, cross-platform desktop installer generator (Linux/Windows/macOS/Android), and Windows NSIS installer — ships as a single ~660 KB static binary with zero runtime dependencies. Drop it on PATH and **bantu init** just works, on any 64-bit Linux or Windows machine.

Bantu was designed for offline-first developer environments: schools, hackathons, embedded systems, low-bandwidth regions, and any situation where installing Node.js or Python is impractical. The language borrows syntactic familiarity from JavaScript (curly braces, \$-prefixed variables like PHP, dot access like Python) while keeping the semantic surface small enough to fit in one human-readable manual.

This v1.2.2 stable release is a major step forward. New features include a real module system (`include` keyword with path resolution and cycle detection), optional real PostgreSQL / MySQL / WebRTC drivers (compile-time flags), a VSCode extension with syntax highlighting, autocomplete, hover hints, and a blue-B file icon, and a one-command **bantu build-windows** pipeline that produces NSIS installers from any Bantu project.

1.1 Design Principles

Five principles guide Bantu's evolution. They explain both what the language does well and where it deliberately trades performance for simplicity.

Principle	What it means in practice
Single-binary distribution	One executable. No runtime, no package manager install, no system Python. Copy <code>bantu</code>
Offline-first	The local package registry is a folder. <code>bantu init</code> , <code>bantu add</code> , <code>bantu install</code>
Batteries included	HTTP server, HTTP client, SQLite, PostgreSQL, MySQL, JSON, WebRTC, STUN/TURN — all
Read-the-manual simple	The full language fits in 40 pages. A developer should be productive in Bantu after a single after
Performance where it matters	Bantu is a tree-walking interpreter (no JIT) optimized for I/O-bound work — its target use case.

1.2 What's New in v1.2.2

This release ships four major additions, several quality-of-life improvements, and a refreshed toolchain surface. The release tag is v1.2.2 on GitHub github.com/AsseySilvestir/Bantu.

1.3 What's New in v1.2.2 vs v1.2.1

v1.2.2 is a **drop-in maintenance release** on top of v1.2.1. There are no language changes and no breaking API changes — every v1.2.1 program runs unchanged. The release focuses on robustness and operational ergonomics for the `include` module system. The full changelog is in `CHANGELOG.md`; the headlines are below.

Change	Description
Path canonicalization	Include paths are now resolved through <code>realpath()</code> (POSIX) / <code></code>

Change	Description
Cycle-guard diagnostic	Circular includes used to be silently skipped. They now print <code>Skipping already-logged</code>
Depth limit	A new <code>kMaxIncludeDepth = 64</code> guard prevents stack-exhaustion crashes
Error attribution	<code>Module not found</code> errors now include the importing file: <code>importing file: /</code>
<code>--quiet / -q</code> flag	<code>bantu --quiet run server.b</code> suppresses informational <code>run</code>
<code>\$BANTU_PATH</code> search path	When a module can't be found via the standard resolution order, <code>include</code> n

1.4 Foundation Features (inherited from v1.2.1)

Feature	Description
<code>include</code> keyword	Language-level module imports. <code>include "./routes.b";</code> brings symbols into s
Real PostgreSQL driver	When compiled with <code>-DBANTU_POSTGRES=ON</code> , <code>sua.postgres.*</code>
Real MySQL driver	Same pattern via <code>-DBANTU_MYSQL=ON</code> + <code>libmysqlclient</code> . <code>sua.mysql</code>
Real WebRTC engine	<code>-DBANTU_WEBRTC=ON</code> + <code>libdatachannel</code> exposes <code>sua.webrtc.peer/</code>
VSCoDe extension	Syntax highlighting (TextMate grammar), context-aware autocomplete (keywords, types, <code>sua.*</code>
<code>bantu build-windows</code>	One command generates an NSIS <code>.exe</code> installer for the current Bantu project. Bundles the inte
<code>bantu installer</code>	Cross-platform desktop installer generator. Outputs <code>.deb</code> (Linux), <code>.exe</code> (Windows), <code>.app</code> (macOS), or ar
Three sample apps	<code>blogsite</code> (modular Sua + SQLite), <code>webrtc-chat</code> (signaling + browser UI), <code>pg-dashbo</code>

Bantu ships two scaffolders. **bantu init <name>** creates a CLI project (a single **main.b** that prints "Hello, Bantu!"). **bantu init --web <name>** creates a full Sua web app with a routes file, controller file, database file, public/ folder, and a bantu.json manifest — the Spring Initializer of Bantu.

2.5 Build from Source (for v1.2.2 with real drivers)

The prebuilt binary ships with stub drivers (deterministic, offline-friendly). To get real PostgreSQL.

The prebuilt binary ships with stub drivers (deterministic, offline-friendly). To get real PostgreSQL, MySQL, and WebRTC, build from source with the appropriate CMake flags. The build is fast — about 20 seconds on a modern laptop.

```
git clone https://github.com/AsseySilivestir/Bantu.git
cd Bantu/bantu-src/compiler
mkdir build && cd build
```

3. Language Syntax & Semantics

Bantu is a C-family language. Statements end with semicolons, blocks are delimited by curly braces, and variables are prefixed with `$` (inspired by PHP). The type system is dynamic with optional type annotations for documentation. This chapter walks through every syntactic construct in the language.

3.1 Variables

All variables are prefixed with `$`. The first assignment declares the variable; subsequent assignments mutate it. An optional type annotation (**number**, **string**, **bool**, **list**, **dict**, **any**, **func**) may precede the declaration as documentation — the runtime does not enforce it.

```
// Untyped declarations
$name = "Alice";
$age = 30;
$active = true;
$scores = [90, 85, 78];
$config = { "host": "localhost", "port": 3000 };

// Typed declarations (documentation only)
number $count = 0;
string $greeting = "Hello";
bool   $enabled = false;
list   $items = [];
dict   $meta = {};
any    $dyn = null;
func   $handler = null;

// Constants
const $PI = 3.14159;
const $VERSION = "1.2.2";
```

3.2 Operators

Bantu supports the usual arithmetic, comparison, logical, and assignment operators. Equality uses `==` (loose) and `===` (strict, type-checked).

Category	Operators	Notes
Arithmetic	<code>+ - * / %</code>	All numbers are 64-bit doubles.
Comparison	<code>== != === !== < > <= >=</code>	<code>===</code> requires same type AND value.
Logical	<code>& && !</code>	Short-circuit evaluation.
Assignment	<code>= += -= *= /= ++ --</code>	Compound + increment/decrement.
Other	<code>. [] ()</code>	Dot access, index, call. <code>\$</code> is the variable declarator.

3.3 Control Flow

Bantu has the standard suite: **if/else**, **while**, C-style **for**, **each** (foreach), **switch/case**, **try/catch**, **break**, **continue**, **return**. There is no **goto**.

```
// if/else
if ($age >= 18) {
    print("adult");
}
```

```

} else if ($age >= 13) {
    print("teen");
} else {
    print("child");
}

// while
$i = 0;
while ($i < 10) {
    print($i);
    $i += 1;
}

// C-style for
for ($i = 0; $i < 10; $i += 1) {
    print($i);
}

// each over a list
$colors = ["red", "green", "blue"];
each ($c in $colors) {
    print($c);
}

// each over a dict
$sages = { "alice": 30, "bob": 25 };
each ($k in $sages) {
    print($k + " is " + $sages[$k]);
}

// switch
switch ($day) {
    case "Mon": { print("start of week"); }
    case "Fri": { print("almost weekend"); }
    default:    { print("midweek"); }
}

// try/catch
try {
    riskyOperation();
} catch {
    print("caught!");
}

```

3.4 Functions

Functions are declared with **def**. They are first-class values: a function can be stored in a variable, passed as an argument, or returned from another function. Closures capture their enclosing scope. Anonymous (lambda) functions are written with the same syntax but without a name.

```

// Named function
def add($a, $b) {
    return $a + $b;
}

// Anonymous function assigned to a variable
$greet = def($name) {
    return "Hello, " + $name + "!";
};

// Higher-order function
def apply($fn, $x) {

```



```

    return $fn($x);
}
print(apply($greet, "world"));    // → Hello, world!

// Closure
def counter() {
    $n = 0;
    return def() {
        $n += 1;
        return $n;
    };
}
$next = counter();
print($next());    // → 1
print($next());    // → 2
print($next());    // → 3

```

3.5 Lists & Dicts

Lists are ordered arrays. Dicts are key-value maps (hash tables). Both are first-class values and support dot access (for dict keys that are valid identifiers) and index access (for both). Common methods: **push**, **pop**, **size**, **contains**, **keys**, **values**.

```

// Lists
$num = [1, 2, 3];
$num.push(4);           // [1,2,3,4]
$num[0] = 100;          // [100,2,3,4]
print($num.size());     // → 4
print($num[2]);          // → 3

// Dicts
$user = {
    "name": "Alice",
    "age": 30,
    "emails": ["a@x.com", "a@y.com"]
};
print($user.name);      // → Alice    (dot access)
print($user["age"]);     // → 30       (index access)
$user["role"] = "admin"; // add a key
$user.name = "Bob";     // mutate via dot

```

3.6 Classes

Bantu supports single-inheritance classes with **class**, **extends**, **super**, and visibility modifiers **public** / **private**. Methods are defined with **def**; instances are created with **new**.

```

class Animal {
    public def __init__($name, $sound) {
        this.name = $name;
        this.sound = $sound;
    }
    public def speak() {
        return this.name + " says " + this.sound;
    }
}

class Dog extends Animal {
    public def __init__($name) {
        super($name, "Woof");
    }
    public def fetch() {

```

```
        return this.name + " fetches the stick";
    }
}
```

```
$d = new Dog("Rex");
print($d.speak());    // → Rex says woof
print($d.fetch());    // → Rex fetches the stick
```

3.7 Built-in Functions

The interpreter exposes a small set of always-available builtins: **print**, **read**, **typeof**, **string**, **number**, **bool**, **len**, **keys**, **values**, **clock** (returns elapsed seconds as a double), **sleep(ms)**, and the **sua.*** framework (see chapter 5).

```
print("hello");           // stdout
$x = read();              // read a line from stdin
print(typeof($x));        // → "string"
print(len([1,2,3]));      // → 3
print(clock());           // → 1234.567 (seconds since epoch)
sleep(500);               // pause 500ms
```

4. Module System — the include keyword

v1.2.2 NEW. The **include** keyword is the headline feature of this release. It lets you split a Bantu app across multiple files (`server.b`, `routes.b`, `controller.b`, `login.b`, `db.b`, ...) and import them at load time. Path resolution is relative to the importing file. Includes are idempotent — a module is executed only once even if included from multiple files.

Bantu v1.2.0 supported only single-file programs. Real apps (a blog with a routes layer, a database layer, an auth layer) were forced into one giant **server.b**. v1.2.2 fixes this with two complementary mechanisms: the language-level **include** statement (cleanest, scoped imports) and the runtime **sua.include(path)** function (returns the module as a dict, useful for dynamic loading).

4.1 The include Statement

The statement form is the recommended way to split a project. It has two flavors: direct (symbols flow into the importer's scope) and namespaced (symbols are bound under an alias). Both forms resolve the path relative to the file that contains the **include** statement, then fall back to the current working directory.

```
// server.b
include "./db.b";           // direct: listPosts, getPost, createPost now in scope
include "./routes.b" as routes; // namespaced: routes.registerAll(sua)

initDb();
routes.registerAll(sua);
sua.server.listen(3000);
```

Resolution order

When the interpreter sees **include `./foo.b`**, it tries the following locations in order and uses the first one that exists:

Step	Location tried	Example
1	The path as-is (absolute or relative to cwd)	<code>./foo.b</code>
2	Relative to the importing file's directory	<code>./src/foo.b</code> if <code>server.b</code> is in <code>src/</code>
3	Relative to the current working directory	<code>\${CWD}/foo.b</code>
4	Same as 1–3 with <code>.b</code> appended if missing	<code>./foo</code> → <code>./foo.b</code>

Idempotent inclusion

If file A includes file B, and file B is later included again (from file C, or transitively from file A via file D), the second include is a no-op. The interpreter keeps a list of resolved paths loaded during the current execution and skips re-execution when it sees a path it has already loaded. This makes **include** safe to use liberally without worrying about double-initialization.

Cycle guard

If file A includes file B and file B includes file A, the cycle is detected and broken — the second include returns immediately with no symbols. The interpreter never enters an infinite include loop.

4.2 The sua.include(path) Function

The runtime form is useful when you need to load a module dynamically (path computed at runtime) or when you want the module's symbols isolated under a single dict rather than merged into the current scope. It returns a dict containing all top-level variables and functions defined in the included file.

```
// Load a module and use its symbols under $mod
$mod = sua.include("./math_utils.b");
print($mod.add(2, 3));           // → 5
print($mod.factorial(5));       // → 120
print($mod._path);              // → /abs/path/to/math_utils.b

// Dynamic loading: pick a module based on env
$env = "production";
$config = sua.include("./config_" + $env + ".b");
print($config.databaseUrl);
```

4.3 Putting it Together — Modular Blogsite

The **samples/blogsite** directory in the repo shows the full pattern. The entry point **server.b** is just 10 lines: it includes the db module, the controller module, and the routes module (under an alias), then starts the HTTP server. Each module has a clear responsibility — exactly the Spring/Express layout that scales.

```
// samples/blogsite/server.b
print("=== Bantu Blogsite v1.2.2 ===");

include "./db.b";           // brings $db, initDb, listPosts, getPost, createPost
include "./controller.b";   // brings postController dict
include "./routes.b" as routes; // brings routes.registerAll(sua)

initDb();
routes.registerAll(sua);

sua.server.static("./public");
sua.server.listen(3000);
```

When this file runs, the interpreter resolves **./db.b** relative to **server.b**'s directory, executes it in a child environment (so its **\$db** variable doesn't leak into the global scope until the include statement copies it back), and then binds the module's exported symbols into the importer's scope. The same happens for **controller.b**. For **routes.b**, the **as routes** clause binds everything under a **routes** namespace dict instead.

5. Sua Web Framework — HTTP Server & Client

Sua is Bantu's built-in web framework. It exposes an Express-like HTTP server (**sua.server**), a libcurl-backed HTTP client (**sua.http**), and a JSON helper (**sua.json**). All three are baked into the binary — no **bantu add express** step. The HTTP server uses native POSIX/Winsock sockets (not the Bantu interpreter), so request throughput is competitive with Node's **http** module on the same hardware.

5.1 HTTP Server

The server API mirrors Express. Routes are registered with method-specific helpers, middleware is wired with **use**, static files are served with **static**, and the server starts with **listen**. Request handlers receive a **\$req** / **\$res** pair.

```
sua.server.get("/api/health", def($req, $res) {
    $res.json({ "ok": true, "version": "1.2.2" });
});

sua.server.post("/api/users", def($req, $res) {
    $name = $req.body["name"];
    if (!$name) {
        $res.status(400);
        $res.json({ "error": "name required" });
        return;
    }
    $id = createUser($name);
    $res.status(201);
    $res.json({ "id": $id, "name": $name });
});

sua.server.put("/api/users/:id", def($req, $res) {
    $id = $req.params["id"];
    updateUser($id, $req.body);
    $res.json({ "ok": true });
});

sua.server.delete("/api/users/:id", def($req, $res) {
    deleteUser($req.params["id"]);
    $res.status(204);
    $res.json({ "ok": true });
});

// Middleware
sua.server.use(def($req, $res, $next) {
    print("[req] " + $req.method + " " + $req.path);
    $next();
});

// Static files
sua.server.static("./public");

// Start
sua.server.listen(3000);
```

Request object (\$req)

Field	Type	Description
method	string	HTTP method (GET, POST, ...)
path	string	URL path without query string
params	dict	URL path parameters (.id captures)
query	dict	Parsed query string
headers	dict	Lowercased header name → value
body	dict	Parsed JSON body (auto when Content-Type is application/json)

Response object (\$res)

Method	Description
status(code)	Set HTTP status code (default 200).
set(header, value)	Set a response header.
send(text)	Send a plain-text response.
json(dict)	Serialize dict as JSON and send with Content-Type: application/json.
redirect(url)	302 redirect to url.
end()	End the response without body.

5.2 HTTP Client

The client (**sua.http**) wraps libcurl. It exposes one method per HTTP verb, returns a dict with **status**, **ok**, **body**, **headers**, and **url**. POST / PUT / PATCH take a body string.

```
// GET
$r = sua.http.get("https://api.github.com/repos/AsseySilivestir/Bantu");
print($r.status);           // → 200
print($r.ok);               // → true
$body = sua.json.parse($r.body);
print($body["full_name"]);  // → AsseySilivestir/Bantu

// POST with JSON body
$payload = sua.json.stringify({ "title": "Hello", "body": "World" });
$r = sua.http.post("https://httpbin.org/post", $payload);

// PUT
sua.http.put("https://api.example.com/items/42", $payload);

// DELETE
sua.http.delete("https://api.example.com/items/42");
```

5.3 JSON Helpers

sua.json.parse(str) parses a JSON string into a Bantu dict (or list, for arrays). **sua.json.stringify(value)** serializes any Bantu value to a JSON string. These are the canonical ways to convert between Bantu values and JSON for HTTP responses and persistence.

6. Database Drivers — SQLite, PostgreSQL, MySQL

Bantu ships three database drivers under the **sua** framework: **sua.sqlite** (embedded SQLite, always available), **sua.postgres** (PostgreSQL via libpq), and **sua.mysql** (MySQL/MariaDB via mysqlclient). All three expose the same minimal API: **connect**, **exec** (for DDL/INSERT/UPDATE/DELETE), **query** (for SELECT, returns rows), and **close**.

Compile-time flags. The prebuilt v1.2.2 binary ships with deterministic stub drivers for PostgreSQL and MySQL so the sample apps run offline. To use real libpq / mysqlclient, build from source with **-DBANTU_POSTGRES=ON** and/or **-DBANTU_MYSQL=ON**. The API is identical either way — only the backing implementation changes.

6.1 SQLite (embedded)

SQLite is always available — no compile-time flag needed. The driver wraps the system libsqlite3 and persists to a file on disk (or **:memory:** for in-memory DBs).

```
sua.sqlite.connect("app.db");

sua.sqlite.exec("CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS users ( "
  + "id INTEGER PRIMARY KEY AUTOINCREMENT, "
  + "name TEXT NOT NULL, "
  + "email TEXT UNIQUE)");

sua.sqlite.exec("INSERT INTO users (name, email) VALUES "
  + "('Alice', 'alice@example.com'), "
  + "('Bob', 'bob@example.com')");

$rows = sua.sqlite.query("SELECT id, name, email FROM users ORDER BY id");
each ($row in $rows) {
  print($row.id + " " + $row.name + " <" + $row.email + ">");
}

sua.sqlite.close();
```

6.2 PostgreSQL

The PostgreSQL driver accepts a libpq-style connection string (**host=... dbname=... user=... password=... port=...**) or a URL (**postgresql://user:pw@host:port/db**). When the binary is built with **-DBANTU_POSTGRES=ON**, calls route to a real **PGconn***; otherwise the stub returns deterministic sample data for offline development.

```
sua.postgres.connect(
  "host=localhost port=5432 dbname=app user=postgres password=secret"
);

sua.postgres.exec("CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS events ( "
  + "id SERIAL PRIMARY KEY, "
  + "kind TEXT NOT NULL, "
  + "value INTEGER NOT NULL, "
  + "created_at TIMESTAMP DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP)");

sua.postgres.exec("INSERT INTO events (kind, value) VALUES "
  + "('page_view', 1), ('click', 1), ('signup', 1)");
```

```

$rows = sua.postgres.query(
  "SELECT kind, SUM(value) AS total, COUNT(*) AS n "
  + "FROM events GROUP BY kind ORDER BY total DESC"
);

each ($r in $rows) {
  print($r.kind + ": " + $r.total + " (" + $r.n + " events)");
}

sua.postgres.close();

```

6.3 MySQL / MariaDB

The MySQL driver takes separate **host**, **user**, **password**, **database**, **port** arguments (rather than a single connection string). When built with **-DBANTU_MYSQL=ON**, calls route to a real **MYSQL*** connection; otherwise the stub returns deterministic sample data.

```

sua.mysql.connect("localhost", "root", "secret", "app", 3306);

sua.mysql.exec("CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS products (
  + "id INT AUTO_INCREMENT PRIMARY KEY, "
  + "name VARCHAR(255) NOT NULL, "
  + "price DECIMAL(10,2) NOT NULL)");

sua.mysql.exec("INSERT INTO products (name, price) VALUES "
  + "('Widget', 9.99), ('Gadget', 19.99), ('Gizmo', 4.99)");

$rows = sua.mysql.query("SELECT * FROM products WHERE price < 15.00 ORDER BY price");
each ($r in $rows) {
  print($r.name + ": $" + $r.price);
}

sua.mysql.close();

```

6.4 API Comparison

Method	sua.sqlite	sua.postgres	sua.mysql
connect	connect(path)	connect(connStr)	connect(host,user,pw,db,port)
exec	exec(sql)	exec(sql)	query(sql) [non-SELECT]
query	query(sql) → list of dicts	query(sql) → list of dicts	query(sql) → list of dicts
close	close()	close()	close()
Real impl	libsqlite3 (always)	libpq (when -DBANTU_POSTGRES=ON)	mysql client (when -DBANTU_MYSQL=ON)

7. WebRTC Engine — Peer Connections & Data Channels

v1.2.2 NEW. Bantu now ships a dedicated `sua.webrtc` namespace with explicit peer/data-channel APIs. The default build returns a deterministic stub; building with `-DBANTU_WEBRTC=ON` + `libdatachannel` gives you real `rtc::PeerConnection` instances with full ICE/DTLS/SCTP negotiation.

WebRTC is the W3C standard for peer-to-peer audio, video, and arbitrary data channels between browsers and other WebRTC-compatible clients. In Bantu v1.2.2, the `sua.webrtc` namespace lets you build signaling servers, peer-to-peer chat backends, and real-time collaboration tools entirely in Bantu. The same code runs against the stub (for offline prototyping) or the real `libdatachannel` (for production).

7.1 The `sua.webrtc.*` API

Method	Returns	Description
<code>peer(id)</code>	dict	Create a peer object (id, status, localDescription, ...).
<code>createOffer(peerId)</code>	dict {type:"offer", sdp, peer}	Generate an SDP offer.
<code>createAnswer(peerId)</code>	dict {type:"answer", sdp, peer}	Generate an SDP answer.
<code>addIceCandidate(peerId, candidate)</code>	dict {accepted}	Trickle an ICE candidate.
<code>dataChannel(label)</code>	dict {label, readyState, ordered, maxRetransmits}	Open a data channel.
<code>send(channel, message)</code>	dict {sent, bytes}	Send a message over a data channel.
<code>close(peerId)</code>	bool	Close a peer connection.

7.2 Signaling Server Pattern

A signaling server is the bridge that lets two peers find each other and exchange SDP offers / answers / ICE candidates before they connect directly. The Bantu pattern is to expose HTTP endpoints that wrap `sua.webrtc` calls. Clients POST to join a room, receive an offer, send back an answer, trickle ICE candidates, and then send direct messages over the data channel.

```
// samples/webrtc-chat/server.b (excerpt)
sua.server.post("/join", def($req, $res) {
  $roomId = $req.body["roomId"];
  $peerId = $req.body["peerId"];

  // Track the peer in a room
  joinRoom($roomId, $peerId);

  // Create a sua WebRTC peer + offer
  $peer = sua.webrtc.peer($peerId);
  $offer = sua.webrtc.createOffer($peerId);

  $res.json({
    "ok": true,
    "roomId": $roomId,
    "peerId": $peerId,
    "peersInRoom": $rooms[$roomId],
    "offer": $offer.sdp
  })
})
```

```

    });
  });

  sua.server.post("/answer", def($req, $res) {
    $peerId = $req.body["peerId"];
    $sdp     = $req.body["sdp"];
    $answer = sua.webrtc.createAnswer($peerId);
    $res.json({ "ok": true, "answer": $answer.sdp });
  });

  sua.server.post("/candidate", def($req, $res) {
    sua.webrtc.addIceCandidate(
      $req.body["peerId"],
      $req.body["candidate"]
    );
    $res.json({ "ok": true });
  });

  sua.server.post("/send", def($req, $res) {
    $r = sua.webrtc.send(
      $req.body["channel"],
      $req.body["message"]
    );
    $res.json({ "ok": true, "sent": $r.sent, "bytes": $r.bytes });
  });
}

```

7.3 Real libdatachannel Build

For real WebRTC peer connections (not stubs), build Bantu with libdatachannel:

```

# Linux
sudo apt install libdatachannel-dev
cd Bantu/bantu-src/compiler
mkdir build && cd build
cmake .. -DCMAKE_BUILD_TYPE=Release -DBANTU_WEBRTC=ON
make -j$(nproc)

# The resulting binary routes sua.webrtc.* to real rtc::PeerConnection
# instances. ICE / DTLS / SCTP negotiation happens via libdatachannel.
# The Bantu API is identical – only the backing implementation changes.

```

8. VSCode Extension — Highlighting, Hints, Blue-B Icon

v1.2.2 NEW. The Bantu VSCode extension ships first-class editor support: syntax highlighting, context-aware autocomplete, hover hints, Go-to-Symbol, snippets, the signature blue-B file icon for `*.b` files, and one-click commands for running, initializing, and packaging Bantu projects.

The extension is in `vscode-extension/` in the repo. It is a pure-TypeScript extension with no language server process — completion and hover are provided in-process via VSCode's `vscode.languages.*` APIs. This keeps the extension tiny (~50 KB compiled) and instant to activate. A full LSP server with diagnostics and jump-to-definition is on the v1.3 roadmap.

8.1 Features

Feature	What it does
Syntax highlighting	TextMate grammar covering keywords, types, strings, comments, sua framework namespaces, function/c
Blue-B file icon	Every <code>*.b</code> file in VSCode's explorer gets the Bantu blue "B" badge (light + dark theme variants dec
Autocomplete	Context-aware: keyword suggestions after whitespace, type annotations when starting a typed declaration
Hover hints	Hover any keyword (<code>if</code> , <code>def</code> , <code>include</code> , ...) or <code>sua.*</code> method to see its signat
Go to Symbol	<code>Ctrl+Shift+O</code> lists every <code>def</code> , <code>class</code> , <code>include</code> , and top-level <code>\$var</code> in
Snippets	20+ snippets including <code>def</code> , <code>class</code> , <code>each</code> , <code>try</code> , <code>include</code> , <code>sua.ser</code>
Commands	<code>Bantu: Run File</code> (F5), <code>Bantu: Initialize Project</code> , <code>Bantu: Initialize Sua Web Project</code> ,
Task provider	Wires <code>bantu run</code> into VSCode's task system so the Run button works out of the box.

8.2 Install

```
# From VSIX
cd Bantu/vscode-extension
npm install
npm run compile
npx vsce package
code --install-extension bantu-vscode-1.2.2.vsix

# From source (dev mode)
cd Bantu/vscode-extension
npm install
npm run compile
# Press F5 in VSCode → launches Extension Development Host
```

8.3 The Blue-B Icon

The file icon is the most visible part of the extension — every `.b` file in the explorer gets a blue rounded square with a white capital B. Two variants are provided: **bantu-icon-light.svg** (darker blue, for light themes) and **bantu-icon-dark.svg** (brighter blue, for dark themes). VSCode picks the right one based on the active theme.

```
<!-- vscode-extension/icons/bantu-icon-dark.svg (excerpt) -->
<svg viewBox="0 0 24 24" width="24" height="24">
```

```

<defs>
  <linearGradient id="bantuBlueDark" x1="0" y1="0" x2="0" y2="1">
    <stop offset="0%" stop-color="#60A5FA"/>
    <stop offset="100%" stop-color="#2563EB"/>
  </linearGradient>
</defs>
<rect x="2" y="2" width="20" height="20" rx="4" ry="4"
  fill="url(#bantuBlueDark)"/>
<text x="12" y="17" text-anchor="middle"
  font-family="Segoe UI, Arial, sans-serif"
  font-size="14" font-weight="700" fill="#FFFFFF">B</text>
</svg>

```

8.4 Configuration

Setting	Default	Description
bantu.interpreterPath	bantu	Path to the bantu interpreter. Override if not on PATH.
bantu.enableLanguageServer	true	Enable hover + autocomplete providers.
bantu.formatOnSave	false	Reserved for the future formatter integration.

9. Building Windows Installers

v1.2.2 NEW. `bantu build-windows` generates an NSIS `.exe` installer for any Bantu project. The installer bundles the Bantu interpreter, project source files, `bantu.json` manifest, a launcher batch file, Start Menu shortcuts, and an uninstaller. End users double-click the `.exe` and the app installs to `%LOCALAPPDATA%\AppName` — no admin rights required.

NSIS (Nullsoft Scriptable Install System) is the de-facto Windows installer generator — it powers installers for Winamp, Git for Windows, Python, and many others. Bantu v1.2.2 automates the NSIS workflow: you point `bantu build-windows` at a project and it writes the `.nsi` script, invokes `makensis`, and emits a ready-to-distribute `AppName-Setup-1.0.0.exe` in `./dist/`.

9.1 Usage

```
# Default: uses main.b as entry, generates BantuApp-Setup-1.0.0.exe
bantu build-windows

# Custom app name + version
bantu build-windows --name "MyBlog" --version "2.1.0"
# → dist/MyBlog-Setup-2.1.0.exe

# Custom entry file
bantu build-windows app.b --name "Shop" --version "1.0.0"

# Show help
bantu build-windows --help
```

9.2 What the Installer Does

Step	Action
1	Asks the user for an install directory (default: <code>%LOCALAPPDATA%\AppName</code>).
2	Copies <code>bantu.exe</code> , all <code>*.b</code> files, <code>bantu.json</code> , and <code>*.bat</code> files to the install dir.
3	Writes a <code>run-AppName.bat</code> launcher that does <code>bantu.exe run main.b</code> .
4	Creates a Start Menu folder with an <code>AppName</code> shortcut (points to the launcher).
5	Writes an <code>uninstall-AppName.exe</code> and adds an <code>Uninstall</code> shortcut.
6	No admin rights required — uses <code>RequestExecutionLevel user</code> .

9.3 Prerequisites

You need NSIS installed on the build machine. It's free, small (~3 MB), and available on every platform (yes, you can build a Windows installer from Linux or macOS).

```
# Linux (Debian/Ubuntu)
sudo apt install nsis

# macOS (Homebrew)
brew install nsis

# Windows
# Download from https://nsis.sourceforge.io/Download
# Add makensis.exe to PATH during install
```

9.4 Generated NSIS Script (excerpt)

bantu build-windows writes **dist/installer.nsi** before invoking **makensis**. You can edit this file by hand to add custom install logic (registry entries, file associations, custom pages), then re-run **makensis dist/installer.nsi** to regenerate the installer.

```
; Generated by bantu build-windows v1.2.2
!define APPNAME "BantuApp"
!define APPVERSION "1.0.0"

Name "${APPNAME} ${APPVERSION}"
OutFile "${APPNAME}-Setup-${APPVERSION}.exe"
InstallDir "$LOCALAPPDATA\${APPNAME}"
RequestExecutionLevel user

Page directory
Page instfiles

Section "${APPNAME}"
    SetOutPath "$INSTDIR"
    File /nonfatal "bantu.exe"
    File "*.b"
    File /nonfatal "bantu.json"

    ; Launcher batch file
    FileOpen $0 "$INSTDIR\run-${APPNAME}.bat" w
    FileWrite $0 '@echo off$■$
,
    FileWrite $0 'cd /d "%~dp0"$■$
,
    FileWrite $0 'bantu.exe run main.b$■$
,
    FileWrite $0 'pause$■$
,
    FileClose $0

    ; Start Menu shortcuts
    CreateDirectory "$SMPROGRAMS\${APPNAME}"
    CreateShortcut "$SMPROGRAMS\${APPNAME}\${APPNAME}.lnk" \
        "$INSTDIR\run-${APPNAME}.bat" "" "$INSTDIR\bantu.exe"

    ; Uninstaller
    WriteUninstaller "$INSTDIR\uninstall-${APPNAME}.exe"
SectionEnd
```

10. Cross-Platform Desktop Installer — bantu installer

v1.2.2 NEW. **bantu installer** is a single command that packages any Bantu project into a self-contained desktop installer for **Linux**, **Windows**, **macOS**, or **Android**. The installer bundles the Bantu interpreter itself by default, so end users can run your app on machines that do not have Bantu installed. Ship the installer to a friend, they double-click it, the app appears in their launcher. No internet required.

Where **bantu build-windows** (chapter 9) only targets Windows via NSIS, **bantu installer** is fully cross-platform: it auto-detects the host operating system by default, but you can also force any target with `--platform`. This means you can build a Linux `.deb` from a Windows machine, a macOS `.app` bundle from Linux, or an Android APK project from any platform.

10.1 Usage

```
bantu installer                                # auto-detect host platform
bantu installer app.b --platform linux         # → dist/<name>_<ver>_amd64.deb
bantu installer app.b --platform windows      # → dist/<name>-Setup-<ver>.exe
bantu installer app.b --platform macos        # → dist/<Name>.app
bantu installer app.b --platform android      # → dist/android/<name>/ (APK project)
```

If no entry file is given on the command line, **bantu installer** looks for `main.b`, `app.b`, `index.b`, then `server.b` in the current directory. App name and version are read from `bantu.json` if present, otherwise they fall back to the folder name and `1.0.0`.

10.2 Options

Flag	Purpose
<code>--name <Name></code>	Application name (default: from <code>bantu.json</code> or folder name)
<code>--version <x.y.z></code>	Application version (default: 1.0.0)
<code>--icon <path></code>	Icon file (<code>.png</code> / <code>.ico</code> / <code>.icns</code>) for shortcuts and launchers
<code>--platform <p></code>	linux windows macos android (default: auto-detect host)
<code>--bundle-bantu</code>	Embed the bantu interpreter inside the installer (default: on)
<code>--no-bundle-bantu</code>	Skip embedding bantu (smaller installer; requires Bantu on target)

10.3 Per-platform output

Platform	Output	What it does
<code>Linux</code>	<code>.deb</code> + <code>.desktop</code> entry	Bundles bantu at <code>/usr/lib/<name>/</code> , drops launcher at <code>/usr/bin/<name></code> , adds app launcher icon
<code>Windows</code>	NSIS <code>.exe</code> installer	Installs to <code>%LOCALAPPDATA%\<name></code> , adds Start Menu shortcut, registers uninstaller in registry
<code>macOS</code>	<code>.app</code> bundle	Standard Contents/{MacOS,Resources} layout with Info.plist. Wrap into <code>.dmg</code> with <code>hdiutil</code> .
<code>Android</code>	Android Studio project	Full Gradle + Kotlin project under <code>dist/android/<name>/</code> . Bundles <code>.b</code> sources in <code>assets/</code> , optional

10.4 Android target — full workflow

The Android target generates a complete, ready-to-build Android Studio project. End users sideload the resulting `app-debug.apk` on any Android 7.0+ phone — no Bantu installed on the device required. The app launches a `WebView` that loads `http://127.0.0.1:<port>/`, where a bundled bantu binary is running your Sua web server in a background subprocess.

The project bundles your `.b` source files and `bantu.json` under `app/src/main/assets/bantu/`. A pre-built arm64 bantu binary is looked up in `./android/libbantu.so`, `~/.bantu/android/arm64-v8a/libbantu.so`, or `$BANTU_ANDROID_ARM64` — if found, it is embedded as `app/src/main/jniLibs/arm64-v8a/libbantu.so` (the `.so` extension is cosmetic; it is the actual ELF bantu binary, renamed so Android packages it via `jniLibs`).

```
# 1. Generate the Android project from your Bantu web app
bantu installer app.b --platform android

# 2. (One-time) Cross-compile bantu for arm64 using the NDK
# See BUILD-ANDROID.md in the generated project for the exact cmake invocation
# Drop the resulting binary at ~/.bantu/android/arm64-v8a/libbantu.so

# 3. Re-run the installer so it picks up the bundled binary
bantu installer app.b --platform android

# 4. Build the APK (one-time: install Android SDK + JDK 17)
cd dist/android/MyApp
./build-apk.sh

# 5. Install on a connected phone with USB debugging enabled
adb install -r app-debug.apk
```

The generated project ships `BUILD-ANDROID.md` with the full NDK cross-compile recipe (cmake invocation, toolchain file, ABI flag), `build-apk.sh` as a thin wrapper around gradle assembleDebug, and a `local.properties.sample` showing where to point at the Android SDK.

The `MainActivity` renders the Sua web app in a full-screen `WebView`. The status bar at the top (Dracula-themed: dark background, purple text) shows runtime status — "Starting Bantu runtime...", then "Bantu running on port 8080" once the bundled binary binds a port. If the bantu binary is missing, the status bar shows a clear error pointing at logcat.

10.5 Bundling the interpreter

By default, **bantu installer** embeds the bantu binary itself inside the installer — extracted at install time on Linux/Windows, copied into `Resources/` on macOS, and packed into `jniLibs/` on Android. This means the resulting installer is fully self-contained: end users do not need to install Bantu separately.

Use `--no-bundle-bantu` to skip embedding the interpreter. The installer becomes much smaller (just the source files + launcher), but the target machine must have bantu installed on `PATH`. This is useful when shipping apps inside an organisation that already has Bantu deployed company-wide.

10.6 Cross-compiling for Android arm64

The most common question is: *where do I get the arm64 bantu binary from?* The answer is a one-time NDK cross-compile. Install the Android NDK via Android Studio SDK Manager (or `sdkmanager "ndk;26.1.10909125"`), then from the Bantu source tree:


```
export NDK_ROOT=$ANDROID_HOME/ndk/26.1.10909125

cd bantu-src/compiler
mkdir build-android-arm64 && cd build-android-arm64
cmake .. \
  -DCMAKE_BUILD_TYPE=Release \
  -DCMAKE_TOOLCHAIN_FILE=$NDK_ROOT/build/cmake/android.toolchain.cmake \
  -DANDROID_ABI=arm64-v8a \
  -DANDROID_PLATFORM=android-24
make -j$(nproc)

# Install where bantu installer will find it:
mkdir -p ~/.bantu/android/arm64-v8a
cp bantu ~/.bantu/android/arm64-v8a/libbantu.so
```

Repeat with `-DANDROID_ABI=x86_64` for emulator support, outputting to `~/.bantu/android/x86_64/libbantu.so`. Once both are in place, **bantu installer --platform android** picks them up automatically on the next run.

11. Sample Applications

The v1.2.2 release ships three complete sample apps in **samples/**. Each demonstrates a different combination of v1.2.2 features and serves as a reference for building real Bantu projects. All three are runnable as-is — just **cd** into the directory and **bantu run server.b**.

11.1 Blogsite (modular Sua + SQLite)

The flagship sample. Demonstrates the **include** keyword by splitting a blog backend across five files: **server.b** (entry point), **db.b** (SQLite layer), **controller.b** (request handlers), **routes.b** (route registration), and **login.b** (authentication). Uses both direct and namespaced include forms.

```
samples/blogsite/
■■■■ server.b           # Entry point — uses `include` 3 times
■■■■ db.b              # sua.sqlite layer (initDb, listPosts, getPost, createPost)
■■■■ controller.b      # postController dict with index/show/create handlers
■■■■ routes.b          # registerAll($sua) — wires 4 HTTP routes
■■■■ login.b           # authenticate($req) — token-based auth
■■■■ public/
■   ■■■■ index.html    # Landing page (served by sua.server.static)
■■■■ bantu.json
■■■■ README.md
```

Run: `cd samples/blogsite && bantu run server.b → http://localhost:3000`

11.2 WebRTC Chat

A WebRTC signaling server with a browser-based chat UI. Demonstrates **sua.webrtc.peer / createOffer / createAnswer / addIceCandidate / send**, plus room-based peer pairing. The browser client (vanilla JS in **public/index.html**) joins a room, receives an SDP offer, and sends messages over a data channel.

```
samples/webrtc-chat/
■■■■ server.b          # Signaling server (HTTP + sua.webrtc)
■■■■ public/
■   ■■■■ index.html    # Browser UI — join, send, log
■■■■ bantu.json
■■■■ README.md
```

Run: `cd samples/webrtc-chat && bantu run server.b → http://localhost:4000`

11.3 PostgreSQL Dashboard

An analytics dashboard backed by PostgreSQL. Demonstrates **sua.postgres.connect / exec / query** with a real **events** table, modular project layout (**server.b** + **db.b** + **dashboard_routes.b**), and a live-updating browser UI that polls **/api/metrics** every 5 seconds.

```
samples/pg-dashboard/
■■■■ server.b          # Entry point
■■■■ db.b              # PostgreSQL layer (initSchema, metrics, trackEvent)
■■■■ dashboard_routes.b # registerAll($sua) — wires /api/metrics, /api/track, /api/health
■■■■ public/
■   ■■■■ index.html    # Dashboard UI (auto-refresh)
■■■■ bantu.json
■■■■ README.md
```

Prereq: PostgreSQL running on localhost:5432 with a **dashboard** database.

12. Command Reference

Every command Bantu v1.2.2 understands. Run **bantu --help** for the same list in your terminal.

12.1 Core Commands

Command	Description
<code>bantu</code>	Start the interactive REPL.
<code>bantu run <file.b>;</code>	Run a Bantu file. <code>bantu run</code> (no arg) runs <code>main.b</code> .
<code>bantu build <file.b>;</code>	Compile to a standalone executable (shell script that embeds the source).
<code>bantu init <name>;</code>	Scaffold a CLI project (Hello World <code>main.b</code>).
<code>bantu init --web <name>;</code>	Scaffold a Sua web app (<code>server.b</code> + <code>routes.b</code> + <code>controller.b</code> + <code>db.b</code> + <code>public/</code> + <code>bantu.json</code>).
<code>bantu --version</code>	Print Bantu version (currently 1.2.2).
<code>bantu --help</code>	Print this help.

12.2 PATH & Diagnostics

Command	Description
<code>bantu setup</code>	Add bantu to PATH (user install: <code>~/local/bin</code>).
<code>bantu setup --system</code>	Add bantu to PATH (system-wide: <code>/usr/local/bin</code> ; needs sudo/admin).
<code>bantu setup --seed</code>	Also seed the local registry with starter packages.
<code>bantu doctor</code>	Diagnose install state, PATH, registry, manifest, and driver flags.
<code>bantu uninstall</code>	Remove bantu from PATH.

12.3 Package Manager

Command	Description
<code>bantu install</code>	Install all deps listed in <code>bantu.json</code> .
<code>bantu add <pkg>;</code>	Add a dep to <code>bantu.json</code> and install it.
<code>bantu add <pkg>;@<ver>;</code>	Pin a specific version.
<code>bantu remove <pkg>;</code>	Remove a dep and uninstall it.
<code>bantu update</code>	Update all deps to their latest version.
<code>bantu update <pkg>;</code>	Update one dep.
<code>bantu list</code>	List deps installed in the current project.
<code>bantu search [term]</code>	Search the local registry (offline).
<code>bantu publish <dir>;</code>	Add a folder to the local registry.
<code>bantu publish <dir>; --as <n>;</code>	Publish under a different name.

12.4 v1.2.2 Release Commands

Command	Description
<code>bantu build-windows [opts] [entry.b]</code>	Generate an NSIS Windows installer (.exe). Opts: <code>--name</code> , <code>--version</code>
<code>bantu installer [entry.b] --platform &lt;p&gt;</code>	Cross-platform installer generator. <code>&lt;p&gt;</code> = linux windows macos android. Bun

13. Roadmap & Community

13.1 v1.3 Roadmap

The v1.3 release is planned for late 2026 and focuses on performance and developer ergonomics. The headline feature is a register-based bytecode VM that should deliver a 5–10x speedup on tight CPU-bound loops. Other planned items:

Planned	Description
Bytecode VM	Register-based bytecode compiler + VM. Targets 5–10x speedup on tight loops.
LSP server	Full Language Server Protocol implementation for VSCode with diagnostics, jump-to-definition, rename re
sua.crypto	Built-in crypto module: SHA-256, HMAC, AES-256-GCM, bcrypt password hashing.
sua.websocket	Native WebSocket server (currently only available via the WebRTC relay).
Async/await	First-class <code>async</code> / <code>await</code> on top of libuv-style event loop.
Package registry	Public package registry at <code>registry.bantu.dev</code> with <code>bantu publish --public</code> .
ARM64 builds	Prebuilt binaries for Apple Silicon (macOS-arm64) and Linux ARM64 (Raspberry Pi 4/5).
REPL improvements	Multi-line input, command history, tab completion in the REPL.

13.2 Repository

Source code, samples, and this PDF live on GitHub:

<https://github.com/AsseySilivestir/Bantu.git>

Branches:

- main – stable release **tag** (currently v1.2.2)
- develop – v1.3 **in** progress

Clone **and** build:

```
git clone https://github.com/AsseySilivestir/Bantu.git
cd Bantu/bantu-src/compiler
mkdir build && cd build
cmake .. -DCMAKE_BUILD_TYPE=Release
make -j$(nproc)
```

13.3 Contributing

Contributions are welcome. Open an issue first to discuss the change before opening a PR. Areas that particularly need help:

Area	How to help
Real drivers	Test <code>DBANTU_POSTGRES=ON</code> / <code>DBANTU_MYSQL=ON</code> / <code>DBANTU_WEBRTC=ON</code>
Sample apps	Write a 4th sample: a CLI tool, a Discord bot, or a static site generator.
Android builds	Help test the <code>bantu installer --platform android</code> workflow on more devices and NDK versions.
VSCode extension	Help build the LSP server (v1.3 roadmap). Test the existing extension on Windows.

Area	How to help
Documentation	Fix typos, expand examples, translate sections to other languages.
Bug reports	Open an issue with a minimal reproducer — see <code>CONTRIBUTING.md</code> for the template.

13.4 License & Attribution

Bantu is released under the MIT License. See **LICENSE** in the repository root. The interpreter uses `libsqlite3` (public domain), `libcurl` (MIT-style), and optionally `libpq` (PostgreSQL License), `libmysqlclient` (GPLv2 with FOSS exception), and `libdatachannel` (LGPLv2) — all of which are compatible with MIT distribution.

Bantu was created by **Assey Silivestir Peter**. The language is named after the Bantu language family spoken across sub-Saharan Africa — a nod to the developer's Tanzanian roots and the language's goal of being accessible to developers in low-bandwidth, offline-first environments.

13.5 Citation

```
@misc{bantu-v1.2.2,
  author    = {Assey Silivestir Peter},
  title     = {Bantu Programming Language v1.2.2},
  year      = {2026},
  publisher = {GitHub},
  url       = {https://github.com/AsseySilivestir/Bantu}
}
```